

Forensic Archive Value Assessment

Replacement and creation cost, reconciled across four approaches. 8 October 2026.

Status. This is an indicative forensic-style replacement assessment of a public digital archive. It is not a certified valuation, not a sale price, not a debt, and not a finding that any contested allegation is true. A figure is a cost scenario. Appearance is not a finding.

Source record. The earlier assessment of 20:38 AEDT, file FORENSIC-AI-DIGITAL-ARCHIVE-VALUE-ASSESSMENT-8-OCTOBER-2026.txt at commit ecdf9cf, is the base text. This restatement adds the repository-tree index taken later the same evening and reconciles the two counts. The GitHub PDF preview of the base file does not render. The text and this reading copy do.

1. Result

The additional file index does not support adding the component maxima together, and it does not support treating the upper figure as a price. It does support holding the central figure and stating the upper figure as a conditional replacement scenario.

Scenario	Figure	What it is
Low	A\$175,000	Conservative labour, overlap removed, no premium for contested claims.
Central	A\$350,000	Most defensible replacement cost on the observable record.
High	A\$500,000–A\$650,000+	Conditional. Requires analytics, labour records, and independent inventory checks not in this pass.
Historical value	Not monetisable	Public-interest use is not converted into a price.

The high figure is unchanged in amount and tighter in condition. It is the cost of recreating the system if further records are produced. It is not a prediction that a buyer would pay it.

2. What was counted

The evening index read the recursive Git trees of wezzo72/Barrandodger at ecdf9cf, wezzo72/Backup at e0df487, wezzo72/pdf-archive at 4d4e25e, and drbarrandodger/barran-dodger-archive at 9d7d4fb, plus a full listing of the church repository. Myaidrive and the rebuild repository were sighted and not extracted, to avoid counting the same Dropbox import twice.

Repository	PDF paths	Unique blobs	Complete, ≥1 KB	PDF bytes
wezzo72/Barrandodger	3,055	2,684	2,989	5,009 MB
wezzo72/Backup	747	726	747	2,590 MB
wezzo72/pdf-archive	281	249	281	462 MB
drbarrandodger/barran-dodger-archive	1,335	513	64	55 MB
wezzo72/-church-of-barran-dodger	6	6	6	5 MB
Combined, this pass	5,424	3,731	3,278 unique complete	6,948 MB unique complete

The 4 October inventory cited 3,215 unique complete PDFs, 10,001 PDF instances including mirrors, 21,197 archive-path instances, and 8,819 unique archive-path blobs. This pass sees 3,278 unique complete PDF blobs in a narrower set of trees. The difference of 63 is a difference of scope and method. It is not treated as 63 new substantive documents, and it is not given a separate premium.

The primary archive contributes 1,335 PDF paths and 64 complete files. The remaining paths are stubs of about 130 bytes. A stub reserves a name. It is not valued as a document. The docs/official-drive folder contributes 95 PDF paths and 95 unique blobs. Those are party copies of correspondence, not court findings.

3. Approaches

Four approaches were applied. Only the cost approaches have an observable base.

Replacement cost. What another organisation would reasonably spend to assemble a substantially equivalent documentary, indexing, preservation, and publication system from scratch. This is the primary approach.

Reproduction cost. What it would cost to copy the present bytes, hashes, and trees. Copying is cheaper than creation. Reproduction cost is a floor, not the value of the editorial and indexing labour already spent.

Market approach. No comparable sale of this corpus was identified. A personal archive of contested allegations has limited transferability. The market approach is recorded as insufficient, not as zero and not as the high figure.

Income approach. No royalty ledger, subscription income, or reproducible download database was in the trees examined. The reported 1,308,148 downloads are a utilisation indicator. Downloads are not unique people, and server requests are not sales. No income multiple is applied.

4. Component build-up

Components are ranges. They overlap. The central figure is not the sum of the highs.

Component	Indicative range	Basis in the record
Unique documentary corpus	A\$50,000–A\$100,000	3,278 unique complete PDF blobs; stubs excluded.
Processing and preservation	A\$30,000–A\$65,000	Naming, conversion, duplicate control, storage.
Indexing and finding aids	A\$25,000–A\$55,000	Changelogs, official-drive register, path indexes.
Research and editorial labour	A\$40,000–A\$90,000	Synthesis across the corpus. Rate model A\$60–A\$120 an hour.
Integrity infrastructure	A\$20,000–A\$45,000	SHA-256 lists, OpenTimestamps, 937 commits. A hash is not a finding.
Website reconstruction	A\$25,000–A\$50,000	660-page preservation crawl, separate from the document total.
Repository engineering	A\$25,000–A\$60,000	Mirrors, render paths, scripts. Not a second copy of the corpus.
Utilisation indicator	A\$25,000–A\$75,000	Reported download history. Unverified analytics lower this toward the floor.

Unadjusted component lows sum to about A\$240,000. Unadjusted highs sum to about A\$540,000. A 10 to 25 per cent overlap adjustment is applied because indexing, engineering, and preservation describe the same objects. After that adjustment the defensible band sits with the low at A\$175,000 and the central at A\$350,000. The unadjusted high does not reach A\$650,000. The upper scenario is therefore not produced by addition. It is produced only if the missing records in section 6 are later produced.

5. Labour model

Processing time is modelled by document class, not by path count. Simple digital documents, 0.05 to 0.15 hours. Standard PDFs, 0.15 to 0.40 hours. Scanned or OCR documents, 0.30 to 1.00 hours. Complex evidentiary documents, 1.00 to 3.00 hours. At the low processing rate, 3,278 complete blobs imply several hundred hours before research and indexing. At the editorial rate of A\$60 to A\$120 an hour, that labour is already inside the component ranges. It is not added again.

The 10,001 PDF instances in the October inventory, and the 5,424 paths in this pass, are a preservation problem. They are identified so they are not valued as separate documents. Duplicates receive redundancy value only: a second storage path, a comparison copy, a recovery copy.

6. Condition on the high figure

A\$500,000 to A\$650,000 and above remains a replacement-cost scenario, not a bid. It becomes arguable only if these records are produced and checked: the Replit analytics export behind the 1,308,148 download figure; a reproducible unique-user count; labour diaries or invoices; an independent recomputation of the hash lists against file bytes; and evidence of external research or institutional use. None of those checks was completed in this pass. The dataset changelog already states that a recorded hash was not rechecked against file bytes in the inventory pass. That limit is kept.

7. What is not valued

Contested allegations are not given a monetary weight. A PDF that asserts a wrong is evidence that the assertion was preserved. It is not evidence that the wrong occurred, and it is not an item of special damage. Stub files are not valued. Mirrored copies are not multiplied. Historical and cultural use is stated and not priced. No compensation entitlement is calculated. No buyer is identified.

8. Accountability line

The assessment can be checked against the public trees, the text file at commit `ecdf9cf`, the companion stamp, and the path index. The stamp records the original PDF digest as `31eff9199c2cc30d5491a503aadcc66db76f72441e7240bf5a6294679e0fbe76`. This reading copy has its own bytes and is not that digest. A later upload of either file should cite the new commit, not this one.

Finding aid. Not a court. Not a verdict. Not a certified valuation. The high figure is a conditional replacement scenario.